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Ministry of Labour
State of Qatar • دولة قطر

NCCHT
اللجنة الوطنية لمكافحة الإتجار بالبشر
National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking

The National Report on

Combating Human Trafficking

2024

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Address by His Excellency Dr Ali bin Saeed Samikh Al Marri

Minister of Labour and Chair of the National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking



Human trafficking constitutes one of the most egregious violations of human rights and dignity. It involves the illicit exploitation of individuals, whether through forced labour, sexual exploitation, organ trafficking, or other forms of abuse, which effectively strips victims of their fundamental rights. This reprehensible phenomenon is rightly deemed a modern incarnation of slavery, as it disproportionately targets the most vulnerable segments of society, including women, children, and migrant workers, subjecting them to exploitation under the duress of violence, coercion, or manipulation.

The gravity of human trafficking is further underscored by its nature as an organised, transnational crime that generates illicit revenues estimated to be in the billions of dollars annually. This crime has emerged as one of the world's most profitable criminal enterprises, rivalled only by the trade in narcotics and arms. Its adverse impact extends beyond mere financial considerations, inflicting profound social, economic and psychological harm on its victims. The consequences include the disintegration of families, the escalation of poverty and the proliferation of diseases, as well as long-term psychological trauma that can persist throughout a victim's life.

Despite considerable international and regional endeavours aimed at curbing this scourge, human trafficking remains a pervasive challenge, fuelled by factors such as poverty, armed conflict, social discrimination, and inadequacies in legal frameworks in certain jurisdictions. In light of these challenges, it is imperative that governments, international organisations, and civil society collectively intensify their efforts to combat this crime. This must be achieved through the fortification of legal measures, the provision of comprehensive protection for victims, the vigorous prosecution of perpetrators, and the enhancement of public awareness regarding the risks and preventative strategies associated with human trafficking.

In this context, the State of Qatar remains steadfast in its commitment to combating human trafficking by developing legislation, enhancing monitoring mechanisms, and providing the necessary support to victims – all in line with its national vision that places human rights at the heart of its developmental policies. It is, therefore, my honour and privilege to

present the National Report on Combating Human Trafficking for 2024. This report reflects Qatar's unwavering commitment to protecting human rights and combating all forms of human trafficking, based on our firmly held humanitarian principles and in full compliance with our National Vision 2030, which places people at the centre of sustainable development.

This annual report provides an opportunity to highlight the achievements of the National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking, in collaboration with various stakeholders, including government institutions, civil society organisations, and international partnerships, which have reinforced Qatar's leading role in human rights protection and in the fight against this transnational crime. The report also demonstrates the progress our State has made in strengthening the legislative and institutional framework to ensure a safe and fair working environment for all individuals, particularly workers, who constitute a fundamental pillar of our development journey.

Qatar, in line with its national and international commitments, will continue to exert every effort to promote human rights and combat human trafficking by adopting a comprehensive approach based on prevention, protection, prosecution, and international cooperation. This issue will remain one of our top priorities to ensure that no individual on Qatari soil is exposed to any form of exploitation or violation.

Furthermore, the State of Qatar is making significant efforts to address the structural causes that lead to human trafficking. This is achieved through the effective implementation of comprehensive reforms recently undertaken to protect migrant workers and support their rights in accordance with international labour standards. Qatar has emerged as a regional leader by completely abolishing the sponsorship system, eliminating exit permits, and facilitating the movement and transfer of workers; by establishing a non-discriminatory minimum wage for both employees and domestic workers; and by enhancing workers' voices and access to effective remedies, while also ensuring additional protection for domestic workers. During 2024, Qatar continued its endeavours aimed at the effective implementation of these reforms, which have substantially reduced the exposure of migrant workers to the risks of forced labour and human trafficking. Efforts have also persisted to improve the available complaint mechanisms and means of reporting violations relating to human trafficking cases, particularly through the hotline of the National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking, which plays a crucial role in providing support and protection to victims, as well as in preparing appropriate facilities to shelter, care for, and rehabilitate them in a manner that respects their needs and human dignity.

In recent years, the State of Qatar has not only enacted legislation to combat human trafficking but has also diligently worked to ensure its effective implementation, particularly during periods marked by significant challenges and achievements. Throughout 2024, Qatar's efforts have been directed towards enhancing its role in upholding human rights and aligning with international

endeavours in this domain, in accordance with Qatar National Vision 2030 and the Third National Development Strategy 2024–2030.

The year 2024 witnessed notable advancements in the legal framework for combating human trafficking and protecting victims. Key developments include:

Enhancement of Legal Framework:
Qatar updated Law No. (15) of 2011 on Combating Human Trafficking to incorporate stricter penalties for offenders and to bolster law enforcement mechanisms aimed at victim protection.
Development of the National Plan to Combat Human Trafficking:
The Ministry of Labour, through the National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking (NCCHT), launched the National Plan to Combat Human Trafficking 2024–2026. This plan unifies national efforts among governmental institutions and civil society organisations to address all forms of human trafficking, focusing on prevention, prosecution, victim protection, and fostering national, regional, and international cooperation.

Strengthening Judicial and Security Cooperation:
Qatar enhanced judicial collaboration with friendly nations and international organisations to combat transnational human trafficking networks. This was achieved through information exchange and training security and judicial personnel in best practices. Notably, the NCCHT and the Supreme Judiciary Council (SJC) signed a memorandum of understanding to bolster cooperation in combating human trafficking and to facilitate the exchange of expertise and relevant information.

Enhancement of Victim Protection Mechanisms:
Qatar developed victim shelter centres and expanded the range of services provided – including legal and psychological support and rehabilitation – to ensure victims are reintegrated into society in a manner that respects their dignity and rights. The NCCHT plays a crucial role in supporting and protecting victims, as well as in establishing appropriate facilities to shelter, care for, and rehabilitate them.

The Ministry of Labour in Qatar places the protection and enhancement of workers› rights at the forefront of its priorities, recognising their essential contribution to the nation›s economic development. To this end, the Ministry has implemented a series of legislative and structural reforms aimed at fostering a fair and sustainable work environment. Key achievements include:

1. Legislative Reforms to Safeguard Workers› Rights:
- Strengthened laws pertaining to wages and working conditions to ensure workers receive their financial and social entitlements.
- Enhanced mechanisms for lodging labour complaints, facilitating prompt and effective resolution of grievances.
- Imposed stricter penalties on violators to ensure adherence to labour laws.

2. Abolition of the Kafala System and Promotion of Labour Mobility:
- Implemented reforms granting workers the freedom to change employers without undue restrictions.
- Strengthened protections against practices that

may amount to forced labour or exploitation.

3. Improvement of Living and Working Conditions:
- Upgraded worker accommodations to provide dignified living environments that comply with health and safety standards.
- Enhanced monitoring and inspection mechanisms to ensure strict enforcement of labour laws and address any violations of workers› rights.

4. Collaboration with International Organisations:
- Strengthened partnerships with the International Labour Organization (ILO) and the International Organization for Migration (IOM) to develop labour policies and combat human trafficking.

Training programmes were implemented for workers and employers to raise awareness of the rights and responsibilities of all parties involved. The Ministry of Labour in Qatar has developed efficient complaint mechanisms to enable workers to report any violations swiftly and easily. Among these resources is a 247/ hotline (16008) that offers assistance in Arabic and English, with translators available for other languages, facilitating effective communication for a diverse workforce.

The Ministry of Labour in Qatar has developed efficient whistleblowing mechanisms to enable workers to report any violations swiftly and easily. Among these resources is a 247/ hotline (16008) that offers assistance in Arabic and English, with translators available for other languages, facilitating effective communication for a diverse workforce. Furthermore, the Ministry has launched a Unified Platform for Complaints and Whistleblowers, enabling citizens, expatriates, and establishments to file complaints against entities subject to Qatar›s Labour Laws. This platform ensures that grievances are addressed promptly and effectively.

To ensure the efficiency of these complaint mechanisms, operators have undergone specialised training in victim identification and referral processes. Workshops have been conducted to equip hotline supervisors and operators with the necessary knowledge and skills to enhance procedures and systems, improving hotline operations. These training programmes cover key areas such as recruitment, response protocols, and the development of appropriate response procedures based on the nature of expected calls, guiding hotline staff to respond appropriately and effectively.

In recognition of the pivotal role played by civil society organisations in assisting victims of human trafficking, the National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking (NCCHT) has sustained its collaboration with the Qatar Red Crescent. This partnership involves the operation and management of the Humanitarian Care Centre, providing shelter and support to victims in accordance with the established memorandum of understanding. Additionally, the NCCHT has engaged with Qatar Charity to bolster assistance for trafficking victims and has coordinated with the Qatar Lawyers Association to offer pro bono legal representation in trafficking cases before the competent judicial authorities.

The State of Qatar remains committed to international cooperation and coordinated efforts to comprehensively address the challenges faced by both source and destination countries. This commitment includes providing legal protection to migrant workers to mitigate the risk of trafficking. These initiatives align with the objectives of the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals, aiming to promote safe and regular migration.

The NCCHT continues its collaboration with the International Organisation for Migration›s mission in Qatar and the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime. These partnerships aim to enhance awareness-raising efforts, build the capacities of national personnel, and deliver comprehensive training to labour inspectors and law enforcement officers. The goal is to effectively detect and address human trafficking offences at early stages.

The 2024 National Report on Combating Human Trafficking presents an overview of the NCCHT›s activities and achievements in victim care. It also monitors legislative developments and highlights collaborations with international organisations and allied nations. The report provides statistical data on the committee›s operations and the complaints received through its hotline, organised around three core areas: legislative frameworks, capacity building, and protection.

Address by Ms. Sarah Abdullah Al-Saadi

Vice-Chairperson of the National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking



Promoting and safeguarding human rights, including combating human trafficking, is a strategic priority for the State of Qatar. Human development, and the protection and enhancement of human rights, are at the forefront of the nation's objectives. In recent years, Qatar has undertaken numerous legislative, institutional, procedural, awareness-raising, and capacity-building measures to combat human trafficking.

The state's efforts to combat human trafficking should be viewed within the context of unprecedented labour market reforms. Enhancing and protecting the rights of migrant workers is a strategic choice for Qatar, which values their contributions and regards them as partners in its developmental and renaissance projects. Over recent years, Qatar has implemented extensive reforms to strengthen labour laws, thereby providing greater protection and guarantees for the rights of migrant workers.

Qatar National Vision 2030 serves as the framework for these reforms, addressing key human rights issues in education, health, the environment, migrant labour rights, women's empowerment, and children's rights. The objectives of this vision are pursued through successive National Development Strategies: the first (2011–2016), the second (2018–2022), and the third (2024–2030).

Notable reforms include the introduction of legislation that abolishes the sponsorship system, permits workers to change employers, eliminates exit permits, and enhances the Wage Protection System. The state has also enacted laws for the election of worker representatives in joint committees, the establishment of a non-discriminatory minimum wage for both employees and domestic workers, the creation of a fund to support and secure workers, improved access to justice through an activated complaints system, and enhanced dispute resolution mechanisms. Additionally, numerous laws have been adopted to combat forced labour and exploitation.

The National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking was established to coordinate national efforts in monitoring, preventing, and combating human trafficking. Its responsibilities include developing and overseeing the implementation of a national action plan, coordinating among various state entities to prevent trafficking crimes,

prosecuting offenders, protecting and caring for victims, providing appropriate shelters, facilitating their rehabilitation, and fostering national and international partnerships.

Recognising the paramount importance of international cooperation and capacity-building to effectively combat all forms of human trafficking, Qatar actively supports joint efforts to address the challenges faced by countries of origin, transit, and destination. The nation strives to enhance the benefits of safe and legal migration in alignment with the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals. Building international partnerships and supporting bilateral and multilateral cooperation with countries, organisations, and regional as well as international unions are among Qatar's strategic objectives.

Qatar has signed numerous bilateral agreements and memoranda of understanding with labour-sending countries to regulate the recruitment of workers, ensuring their protection and the respect of their rights and duties. A significant development in this regard was the signing of a memorandum of understanding with the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime in March 2022 to establish an International Centre for Training and Research in Combating Human Trafficking, hosted by Qatar. The centre aims to enhance capacities and knowledge, encourage partnerships, and effectively prevent, suppress and punish human trafficking while safeguarding victims' rights.

Committed to preserving human dignity and fulfilling its ethical and legal obligations, Qatar actively supports global efforts to combat human trafficking and related issues such as forced labour, modern-day slavery, and child labour. The nation has supported the United Nations Global Plan of Action against Trafficking in Persons since its adoption and is among the largest donors to the UN Trust Fund for Victims of Trafficking. Qatar has hosted several international conferences, including the 13th United Nations Congress on Crime Prevention and Criminal Justice, which adopted a comprehensive approach to combating human trafficking as outlined in the Doha Declaration. The country is also a major supporter of the UNODC, the primary UN body for combating human trafficking.

Address by Her Excellency Najwa bint Abdulrahman Al Thani

Undersecretary of the Ministry of Labour and Secretary-General of the National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking



Human trafficking represents one of the gravest crimes of our time. It poses a severe threat to society and stands in stark contradiction to the highest human values, which guarantee every individual the right to dignity and freedom. This phenomenon is not confined to any single region or nation; it is a global issue that escalates daily, preying upon the vulnerable and marginalised, and reducing them to mere commodities. All divine faiths and international conventions unequivocally condemn such abhorrent practices, recognising the imperative to safeguard individuals from both material and psychological exploitation, and deeming these acts as flagrant violations of human rights and dignity.

Moreover, this crime has evolved into an increasingly complex and organised enterprise. In certain instances, it is perpetrated by structured criminal networks or facilitated via the Internet, thereby compounding efforts to counter it effectively. The United Nations estimates that revenue generated through human trafficking ranks third after those from drug and arms trafficking. Consequently, a robust and coordinated response is mandated at both the national and international levels.

In response to these pressing challenges, the State of Qatar remains steadfast in its fight against human trafficking, driven by an unwavering commitment to upholding human rights and fulfilling its international obligations. Qatar has been at the forefront of supporting the United Nations Global Action Plan to Combat Human Trafficking and has enacted stringent national legislation which criminalises all forms of human trafficking, pursuant to Law No. 15 of 2011 on Combatting Human Trafficking. All related initiatives are implemented in accordance with applicable international conventions and domestic legal instruments, thereby ensuring legal accountability for all involved parties.

As one of the countries that receive a substantial number of migrant workers annually, Qatar recognises its susceptibility to challenges associated with human trafficking. Nonetheless, the State's proactive multi-faceted approach mitigates this risk. Notable progress has been achieved through the enactment of pertinent laws, regulations, and policies governing recruitment and immigration, alongside effective measures designed to safeguard workers' rights and promote a healthy work environment. Key initiatives include robust

cooperation with countries of origin to combat human trafficking and forced labour, ensuring that workers enter Qatar without incurring debilitating debts. To preclude potential manipulation or deceit in the formation of contracts, the Ministry of Labour has introduced bilateral agreements and adopted a unified employment contract. Furthermore, Qatar Visa Centres have been established to streamline the process, enabling workers to sign contracts electronically and receive copies prior to departure, in full compliance with all relevant regulations. These centres also conduct biometric and medical examinations in the workers' home countries, marking a significant advancement in the elimination of recruitment fees.

In conclusion, it is imperative to address the underlying factors that contribute to human trafficking—namely poverty, marginalisation, unemployment, and illiteracy—while providing the necessary support to the most vulnerable segments of society. A concerted national effort must be undertaken to enforce both international conventions and domestic legislation, ensuring robust prevention, vigorous prosecution, and prompt punishment of offenders, as mandated under current legal frameworks. Accordingly, we reaffirm Qatar's resolute commitment to combating human trafficking by implementing relevant international and regional instruments and enhancing cooperation with other nations. Through the full and effective application of Law No. 15 of 2011 on Combatting Human Trafficking, Qatar continues to lead the fight against this phenomenon with modern legislative measures and specialised institutional mechanisms, thereby safeguarding human dignity and ensuring justice for all.

Objectives of the National Report Published Annually by the Committee

The National Report aims to monitor the state's efforts in combating human trafficking crimes, track legislative developments, and oversee cooperation with international organisations and counterparts in friendly countries.

Section One: Legislative Frameworks

The State of Qatar has placed paramount importance on combating human trafficking, grounded in its national principles of respecting human rights. Qatar has acceded to both the United Nations Convention against Transnational Organised Crime and the Protocol to Prevent, Suppress and Punish Trafficking in Persons, Especially Women and Children, which complements the Convention.

Furthermore, Qatar enacted Law No. (15) of 2011 on Combating Human Trafficking, along with its amendments, in full alignment with international standards for addressing human trafficking.

In addition, the Cabinet issued Decision No. (15) of 2017 to establish the National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking. This Committee serves as the national coordinator in monitoring, preventing, and combating human trafficking by developing a national action plan, overseeing its implementation, and coordinating efforts among various state authorities. The Committee is also responsible for prosecuting perpetrators, protecting and providing care for victims, offering suitable housing, ensuring rehabilitation, and fostering both national and international partnerships to combat human trafficking.

Firstly – Provisions Related to the Constitution

The Permanent Constitution of the State of Qatar includes several articles that enhance human rights and prohibit practices such as human trafficking and forced labour. Notable articles include:

- **Article 30:** «No person shall be enslaved, and human trafficking is prohibited. All forms of human exploitation are criminalised.»
- **Article 36:** «Personal freedom shall be guaranteed and no person may be arrested, detained or searched, neither may his freedom of residence and mobility be restricted, save under the provisions of the Law.»
- Article 52: «Every person has the right to work, and the state works to provide job opportunities for citizens and to qualify them.»
- **Article 68:** states that International treaties ratified by the state shall have the force of law meaning that international agreements related to human rights and combating human trafficking become part of national legislation.
- **Article 68:** states that International treaties ratified by the state shall have the force of law meaning that international agreements related to human rights and combating human trafficking become part of national legislation.

Secondly: Ratification of International Conventions Related to Human Trafficking

- Slavery Convention of 1926 and the Supplementary Convention on the Abolition of Slavery, the Slave Trade, and Institutions and Practices Similar to Slavery of 1956, and the International Convention for the Suppression of the Traffic in Persons and of the Exploitation of the Prostitution of Others.
- Convention on Consent to Marriage, Minimum Age for Marriage, and Registration of Marriages of 1962.
- International Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Racial Discrimination of 1965.
- International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights of 1966.
- International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights of 1966.
- Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination against Women of 1976.
- Convention against Torture and Other Cruel, Inhuman, or Degrading Treatment or Punishment of 1987.
- United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child of 1989.
- Optional Protocol to the Convention on the Rights of the Child on the involvement of children in armed conflict, and the Optional Protocol to the Convention on the Rights of the Child on the sale of children, child prostitution, and child pornography of 2000.
- United Nations Convention against Transnational Organised Crime of 2000, and the Protocol to Prevent, Suppress and Punish Trafficking in Persons, Especially Women and Children, and the Protocol against the Smuggling of Migrants by Land, Sea and Air, supplementing the Convention.
- Convention Concerning the Prohibition and Immediate Action for the Elimination of the Worst Forms of Child Labour of 1999.
- Qatar has also ratified most of the major conventions issued by the International Labour Organization (ILO).

Thirdly: Enactment of Specific Legislation to Combat Human Trafficking

In alignment with the Qatari Constitution, the Criminal Procedure Law No. (23) of 2004, as amended by Law No. (24) of 2009, and Decree No. (10) of 2009 approving accession to the United Nations Convention against Transnational Organised Crime of 2000, Law No. (15) of 2011 on Combating Human Trafficking was enacted. This law, further amended by Law No. (5) of 2020, comprises 28 articles detailing the criminalisation of human trafficking offences and prescribing stringent penalties for offenders. It precisely defines the crime, outlines victim protection measures, and emphasises international judicial cooperation.

Legislative Developments to Enhance Protection Against Human Trafficking

In 2023, the National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking recommended amendments to the Human Trafficking Law, issued under Law No. (15) of 2011, aiming to strengthen measures against human trafficking and provide greater protection for victims. These recommendations were presented to the Shura Council (Parliament).

In April 2023, the Qatari Cabinet approved the proposed amendments. These changes were formalised in Law No. (21) of 2024, which modifies certain provisions of Law No. (15) of 2011 and was ratified by His Highness the Emir on 15 December 2024. The amendment includes the addition of Article 5, Paragraph 2, which states that the Ministry of Interior shall bear any costs related to the repatriation of victims.

Qatar is the first country in the world to designate a government body to cover the costs of victim repatriation. This provision assigns the responsibility for covering the expenses of returning victims to their home countries to the Ministry of Interior, taking into account their humanitarian circumstances. This is a global precedent, as most legislation combating human trafficking does not designate a specific entity to cover repatriation costs. This measure reflects Qatar's commitment to ensuring the protection of victims of human trafficking in line with the highest international standards. Additionally, items 8 and 9 were added to Article 6 of the Human Trafficking Law, specifying that:

- The necessary procedures should be implemented to regularise the victims› status in the country, in coordination with the relevant authorities; and
- Victims should be placed in one of the specialised centres for shelter, rehabilitation, or with an accredited entity that commits to providing accommodation if required.

This legal provision permits the modification of the legal status of human trafficking victims or migrant smuggling victims. Previously, victims were often hesitant to report such crimes due to fears of deportation—particularly in cases of forced labour, as many had come to Qatar seeking work and a better life. Employers might engage in abusive practices, and victims frequently faced various forms of intimidation. Global laws generally mandate the repatriation of human trafficking victims to their home countries or places of permanent residence, which has deterred many from reporting trafficking for fear of being returned to unfavourable conditions.

To encourage victims to report trafficking crimes, the authorities adopted a recommendation issued by the Public Prosecution to modify the legal status of victims. This recommendation is nearly obligatory for all government entities. Consequently, the National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking advocated for the inclusion of this recommendation as a binding legal measure to ensure comprehensive protection for trafficking victims and to encourage them to report such crimes.

The amendment also allows victims to choose the most appropriate shelter in the country based on their individual needs, including placement in a specialised care house or rehabilitation centre, or with an accredited entity that agrees to provide accommodation if required.

The Definition of Human Trafficking under the Law of the State of Qatar Article 2 of Law No. (15) of 2011 on Combating Human Trafficking defines the crime of human trafficking as any person who uses, transports, transfers, harbours, receives, or takes control of another person, whether within the country or across its borders, through the use of force, violence, threats, kidnapping, fraud, deception, abuse of power, exploitation of vulnerability or need, or by offering or receiving financial or other benefits to obtain the consent of a person controlling another for the purpose of exploitation. This definition includes, but is not limited to, exploitation in prostitution or other forms of sexual exploitation, exploitation of children in such activities and in pornography, forced labour or services, slavery or practices similar to slavery, servitude, or the removal of organs or tissues.

Additionally, Article 1 of Law No. (5) of 2020, which amended certain provisions of Law No. (15) of 2011, defines an organised criminal group as a group consisting of at least three persons, operating in a structured manner—either continuously or for a specified period—with the aim of committing human trafficking offences or migrant smuggling offences, either alone or in conjunction with other crimes, in order to obtain, directly or indirectly, financial or other material benefits.

Fourthly – Penal Code (Law No. (11) of 2004) and its Amendments

In addition to the Human Trafficking Law, the Qatari Penal Code (Law No. (11) of 2004) includes several provisions specifically addressing human trafficking, forced labour, and the protection of human rights. For example:

- Article 157: Whoever, being a public officer involved in employing workers in jobs related to his office, retains for himself all or part of their due salaries or other due benefits, employs directly or indirectly chore workers and takes their salaries, writes down in the books of the authorities mentioned in Article 4 hereof the names of fictitious or real persons who did not carry out any of the mentioned jobs, takes possession of their salaries or pays the salaries into the bank accounts of the said persons shall be punished with imprisonment for a term not exceeding seven years.

- Article 321: Whoever brings into or takes out of Qatar a person as a slave, or buys, sells, or donates a person as a slave, shall be liable to imprisonment of a term not exceeding seven years.

  Whoever imports, exports, buys, sells, traffics, offers or gives as a gift or disposes of any person as a slave, shall be punished with imprisonment for a term which may extend up to seven years.

- Article 322: Whoever forcibly, takes somebody to work with or without salary shall be liable to imprisonment of a term up to six months and a fine not exceeding three thousand Qatari Riyals (QR 3.000), or one of these two penalties.

  If the victim is under sixteen years of age, the penalty shall be up to six years in prison and/or a fine not exceeding ten thousand Qatari Riyals (10.000QR).

These provisions reinforce Qatar's commitment to safeguarding human rights and preventing human trafficking and forced labour, ensuring robust legal measures are in place to protect workers from exploitation.

Fifthly – Labour Law

The Qatari Labour Law No. (14) of 2004, along with its amendments, includes provisions to ensure the protection of workers from any form of exploitation. The most important provisions are as follows:

- Article 38: "Employment Contracts shall be in writing and ratified by the Department, and it shall be made in three copies; each party shall receive a copy, and the third copy shall be deposited with the Department..."
- Article 39: "The work contract may state placing the worker on a probation period to be agreed on between the two parties provided that the probation period shall not exceed six months from the date of commencement of the work."
- Article 49: "Either party of the employment contract, may, after the end of the probationary period, or in case the probationary period is not provided for in the employment contract, terminate the contract without giving reasons, provided that the party wishing to terminate the contract takes into account notifying the other party in writing of his desire to do so, according to the notice periods indicated below..."

In addition, the Qatari Labour Law (Law No. (14) of 2004) prohibits the employment of non-Qatari workers without the administration's approval and the issuance of a work permit, in accordance with the rules and procedures set by the Ministry. Law No. (17) of 2020 was issued to establish a minimum wage for domestic workers, thereby enhancing workers' rights in Qatar.

Sixth – Law on the Use of Human Body Organs

Law No. (15) of 2015 regulates the process of human organ transplantation and donation in Qatar. Key provisions include:

- Article 10: "It is prohibited to engage in any transaction involving the sale, purchase, or exchange of any organ, part, tissue, or cell of the human body for any consideration whatsoever. It is also prohibited to advocate for or promote such practices."
- Article 5: "A legally eligible person may donate or command one or more of his or her organs, parts, tissues, or cells to one or more patients for the purpose of treatment, in accordance with the controls and procedures stipulated in this law."
- Article 4: "It is not permissible to transfer an organ, part, tissue, or cells from the body of a living human being for transplantation into the body of another, except in cases where it is necessary to preserve the life of the recipient or treat a serious disease. The transfer must be the sole possible medical means of treatment, and must comply with the controls and procedures stipulated in this law."

These articles emphasize the importance of organ donation as a voluntary act without compensation, establishing the necessary regulations to ensure the safety of both the donor and the recipient.

Section Two: Building National Capacities

First: The National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking

The National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking was established by Cabinet Decision No. (15) of 2017 to serve as the national coordinator in monitoring, preventing, and combating human trafficking through close coordination with the relevant authorities. The Committee comprises representatives from the following entities:

1. A representative from the Ministry of Foreign Affairs – Vice-Chair.Al Tamimi & Company+1BizFin News+1
2. Two representatives from the Ministry of Interior.
3. A representative from the Ministry of Justice.
4. A representative from the Ministry of Public Health.
5. A representative from the Public Prosecution.
6. A representative from the Government Communications Office.
7. A representative from the National Human Rights Committee.
8. A representative from the Qatar Foundation for Social Work (Protection and Social Rehabilitation Centre).

In accordance with Cabinet Decision No. (15) of 2017, as amended by Cabinet Decision No. (4) of 2021, the Committee is tasked with:

1. Developing the National Plan to Combat Human Trafficking and preparing the programs and mechanisms required for its implementation, in coordination with the competent national entities.
2. Establishing a database that contains international legislation related to human trafficking, trafficking methods, and relevant studies.
3. Reviewing national legislation to ensure its consistency with the international conventions and treaties ratified by the State.
4. Preparing and publishing an annual report on the State's efforts to prevent, monitor, and combat human trafficking.
5. Studying international and regional reports related to the prevention, monitoring, and combating of human trafficking, and taking appropriate measures in response.
6. Coordinating with the competent authorities and relevant bodies to ensure protection and support for victims of human trafficking, including the provision of protective and rehabilitation programs aimed at assisting victims in their reintegration into society.
7. Raising awareness of the means and dangers of human trafficking by organizing conferences, seminars, issuing publications, delivering training programs, and initiating other activities that serve the Committee's objectives.
8. Exchanging information and expertise with Arab, regional, and international organizations and national committees concerned with combating human trafficking, thereby strengthening cooperation with them.
9. Participating alongside national authorities in international conferences and forums related to combating human trafficking.
10. Carrying out any other tasks assigned to the Committee in the field of combating human trafficking.

Legislative and Legal Framework of the Committee's Work

The Committee's work is founded upon Law No. (15) of 2011 on Combating Human Trafficking, as amended by Law No. (5) of 2020 and, most recently, by Law No. (21) of 2024. This legislation, which aligns with the relevant international standards, underpins the activities of governmental bodies and civil society organisations in this field. It further regulates cooperation between competent judicial authorities and their foreign counterparts concerning the prosecution of perpetrators, the exchange of information, the conduct of investigations, mutual legal assistance, judicial cooperation, asset recovery and other forms of judicial collaboration. All such cooperation is to be carried out in accordance with the rules prescribed in Law No. (23) of 2004 on Criminal Procedure and its subsequent amendments, as well as under any applicable bilateral or multilateral agreements or on the basis of reciprocity, so long as these arrangements do not conflict with the fundamental principles of the State's legal system.

The aforementioned Criminal Procedure Law further provides that competent judicial authorities may order the execution of final criminal judgments issued by foreign judicial authorities concerning the seizure, confiscation or recovery of assets obtained from human trafficking offences and their proceeds.

Second: The Department for Combating Trafficking in Persons at the Ministry of Interior

The Ministry of Interior has established a dedicated Unit for Combating Human Trafficking, tasked with addressing all crimes related to human trafficking and migrant smuggling. This department is responsible for conducting investigations and initiating legal proceedings in such cases, ensuring a specialised and focused approach to these serious offences.

Third: The Specialised Department within the Public Prosecution

Upon the enactment of Law No. (15) of 2011 on Combating Human Trafficking, the authority to investigate and prosecute human trafficking offences was initially assigned to the local prosecution departments within the Public Prosecution, each according to its territorial jurisdiction. However, in 2019, His Excellency the Attorney General issued Decision No. (39) of 2019, conferring exclusive jurisdiction over human trafficking offences to the Residency Affairs Department within the Public Prosecution. This measure centralised all human trafficking cases within a single competent department with nationwide jurisdiction, thereby enhancing consistency and specialisation in case handling.

In preparation for this responsibility, the Public Prosecution organised specialised training programmes—both domestic and international—for its members, enabling direct engagement with international organisations and jurisdictions with established expertise in combating human trafficking. Upon successful completion of these capacity-building initiatives, His Excellency the Attorney General issued Decision No. (17) of 2022, appointing four prosecutors specialised in human trafficking offences to serve within the Residency Affairs Department alongside their existing responsibilities. Subsequently, on 23 January 2024, His Excellency the Attorney General issued a decision amending the department's designation to the Department for Residency and Human Trafficking Affairs, thereby formally recognising its dual mandate.

Fourth: The Competent Judicial Authority

In the State of Qatar, the competent court for hearing human trafficking cases is the Third Criminal Circuit of the Court of First Instance. This circuit was established by Decision No. (18) of 2023, dated 24 September 2023, and Decision No. (16) of 2024, dated 2 September 2024, both issued by the President of the Court of First Instance as part of the formation of judicial circuits for the 2023–2024 and 2024–2025 judicial sessions.

The Third Criminal Circuit is entrusted with adjudicating cases referred by the Department for Residency and Human Trafficking Affairs, including human trafficking and related crimes. It functions as a specialised judicial body, composed of qualified judges trained to examine and decide such cases efficiently and in accordance with the highest international standards and best practices.

Fifth: Partnership Building

Enhancing international cooperation and fostering strategic partnerships are key priorities. These efforts are pursued through the establishment of international partnerships and the strengthening of bilateral and multilateral relations with countries, organisations, and both international and regional unions. The objective is to benefit from international expertise in combating human trafficking.

The National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking works to develop partnerships with various countries and organisations to facilitate the exchange of expertise, in collaboration with the International Organization for Migration (IOM) and the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC). Furthermore, two Memoranda of Understanding have been signed with the United States of America in the areas of labour and combating human trafficking, and the Ministry holds regular meetings with the American side to exchange experiences and best practices.

1 Key International and Regional Agreements and Treaties on Combating Human Trafficking to Which the State of Qatar is a Signatory:

1. The United Nations Convention against Transnational Organised Crime (2000) – ratified by Decree No. (10) of 2009.
2. The Arab Convention against Transnational Organised Crime – ratified by Decree No. (36) of 2012.
3. The Convention on the Rights of the Child – ratified by Decree No. (54) of 1995
4. The Optional Protocol to the Convention on the Rights of the Child on the Sale of Children, Child Prostitution and Child Pornography – ratified by Decree No. (36) of 2010.
5. The Optional Protocol to the Convention on the Rights of the Child on the Involvement of Children in Armed Conflict (2000).
6. The Worst Forms of Child Labour Convention (1999) and its associated immediate action measures for elimination.

2 Memoranda of Understanding and Local Cooperation Agreements Concluded by the Committee:

1. A Memorandum of Understanding between the Ministry of Labour, represented by the National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking, and Msheireb Properties (31 July 2021).
2. A Memorandum of Understanding between the Ministry of Labour, represented by the National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking, and the Qatar Red Crescent Society (21 April 2019).
3. A Memorandum of Understanding between the Ministry of Labour, represented by the National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking, and Qatar Charity (2019).

3 Cooperation with International Organisations and Counterpart Institutions in Friendly States:

1. A Memorandum of Understanding was signed between the State of Qatar and the Republic of the Philippines on cooperation in combating human trafficking (April 2024).
2. A Memorandum of Understanding was signed between the Ministry of Labour and the Doha Office of the International Labour Organization (ILO), comprising two phases of a technical cooperation programme. The first phase (2018–2021) focused on significant legislative and policy reforms to improve the working environment, while the second phase (2021–2023) supported the implementation of these reforms.
    1. A Memorandum of Understanding on cooperation in combating human trafficking was signed between the Ministry of Labour, represented by the National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking, and the Human Rights Commission of the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia (16 April 2023).
    2. A Memorandum of Understanding was signed between the Ministry of Labour, the Government of the Netherlands, and the International Labour Organization to strengthen cooperation in dispute resolution, social dialogue, and wage protection; this agreement also aimed to build the capacities of the Ministry's staff on joint labour committees and enhance labour dispute mechanisms (12 January 2023).

3. The Ministry of Labour signed a Declaration of Intent with the Government of the French Republic in collaboration with the International Labour Organization to cooperate on social dialogue, non-discrimination, inspection, and the enhancement of recruitment platforms; this initiative seeks to promote the exchange of experiences and best practices in rights protection (27 March 2022).

4. The Ministry of Labour has concluded 47 bilateral agreements with labour-sending countries, including 20 Asian countries, 22 African countries, four European countries, and one South American country, to regulate the recruitment and employment of workers within a legal and rights-based framework that contributes to combating human trafficking.

5. The Ministry also coordinates with labour-sending countries through joint committees established under these agreements, which hold regular meetings to address issues related to the employment and protection of migrant workers in Qatar.

6. Additionally, the Ministry has signed 23 Memoranda of Understanding on labour cooperation with 20 countries, with the objective of exchanging knowledge and expertise, adopting international best practices, and supporting the implementation of Qatar's comprehensive labour reform agenda, including measures to combat human trafficking.

4 Bilateral Enforcement Coordination Measures with Governments:

1. Cooperation was undertaken with the Egyptian authorities regarding the repatriation of victims and the apprehension of suspects.
2. Cooperation was undertaken with the Moroccan authorities regarding the repatriation of victims and the apprehension of suspects.
3. Cooperation was undertaken with the Malaysian authorities regarding the repatriation of victims and the apprehension of suspects.
4. Cooperation was undertaken with the Spanish authorities regarding the repatriation of victims and the apprehension of suspects.
5. Cooperation was undertaken with the Sri Lankan authorities regarding the repatriation of victims and the apprehension of suspects.

Sixth: Activities of the National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking in 2024

1. **First Committee Meeting of the Year:**
   His Excellency Dr Ali bin Samikh Al Marri, Minister of Labour and Chair of the National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking, chaired the first meeting of the Committee in 2024, during which the Committee's action plan to further enhance efforts against human trafficking was discussed.
2. **Participation in the Fifth Government Forum to Combat Human Trafficking – Oman:**
   On 17 April 2024, the State of Qatar, led by His Excellency the Minister of Labour, participated in the Fifth Government Forum for Combating Trafficking in Persons in the Middle East, held in the Sultanate of Oman.
3. **Signing of a Memorandum of Understanding with the Philippines:**
   A Memorandum of Understanding was signed with the Republic of the Philippines to enhance cooperation in combating human trafficking.
4. **Participation in the Fourteenth Meeting of the Working Group on Trafficking in Persons – Vienna:**
   The Committee took part in the 14th session of the UNODC Working Group on Trafficking in Persons in Vienna, Austria, which focused on trafficking for the purpose of organ removal, along with related behaviours, child trafficking, and emerging challenges.
5. **World Day against Trafficking in Persons:**
   The State of Qatar observed World Day against Trafficking in Persons on 30 July 2024, reaffirming its commitment to raise awareness and strengthen anti-trafficking measures.
6. **Participation in the Third National Human Rights Forum:**
   The Ministry of Labour, represented by the Committee, participated in the Third National Human Rights Forum organised by the National Human Rights Committee under the theme "Protecting Children's Rights in a Safe Digital Environment: Challenges and Prospects for Empowerment and Protection."
7. **Committee Progress Review Meeting:**
   His Excellency Dr Ali bin Samikh Al Marri chaired a periodic meeting of the Committee to review

the progress of the 2024 action plan for combating human trafficking.

8. **Participation in the Vienna Annual Conference "Human Trafficking: A Personal Matter?":**
   The Committee participated in this international conference, which explored how traffickers exploit personal relationships and modern technologies, and highlighted the importance of international cooperation in developing effective preventive strategies.
9. **Capacity-Building Training – Doha:**
   The Committee participated in a three-day training course organised by the Public Prosecution's Institute of Criminal Studies, in collaboration with the Supreme Judiciary Council and the U.S. Embassy in Doha. The training, targeting judges, law enforcement personnel, and civil society organisations, aimed to enhance both procedural and substantive capacities in addressing trafficking offences.
10. **International Capacity-Building Workshop – Doha and the United States:**
    The Committee attended a dual-location workshop spanning three days in Doha and five days in the United States. Participants included judges and officials from the Supreme Judiciary Council, Public Prosecution, Ministry of Interior, and Ministry of Labour. The workshop focused on practical and procedural aspects of combating human trafficking, providing valuable insights into international best practices.
11. **Awareness Lecture in Cooperation with the Criminal Investigation Department:**
    An awareness session was organised by the Committee in collaboration with the Criminal Investigation Department to highlight Qatar's national efforts and the Committee's role in combating human trafficking, as part of a series of awareness-raising workshops targeting various sectors of society.

Seventh: The Hotline

The Ministry of Labour has established comprehensive complaint mechanisms that enable workers to report violations efficiently and promptly. Among these mechanisms is the 24/7 hotline, which operates in both Arabic and English, with additional language support provided through interpreters. Complaints can also be submitted via email. In collaboration with the Government Contact Centre, the National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking manages a dedicated hotline for receiving complaints at the number 16044. Upon receiving a complaint, a Government Contact Centre representative classifies the complaint according to the established categories. If necessary, the complaint is referred to the National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking for further review and action.

In addition to the hotline, an electronic service («Contact Us») is available on the Ministry of Interior›s website, and the «Metrash» mobile application facilitates the reporting of human trafficking crimes or the provision of information that could assist law enforcement in investigating or apprehending perpetrators. This platform guarantees complete con-

fidentiality, allowing individuals to report concerns without disclosing their identity or personal information, especially in cases where the reporter or victim fears retaliation. The app is available in multiple languages, including Arabic, English, French, and Urdu, the latter being widely spoken among Qatar's workforce. This multilingual support ensures broad accessibility.

Furthermore, the «Amerni» mobile application has been introduced to enhance accessibility, providing an additional avenue for individuals to report incidents related to human trafficking or other violations in a confidential and secure manner. A unified electronic platform for complaints has also been launched, allowing workers to report workplace-related issues directly.

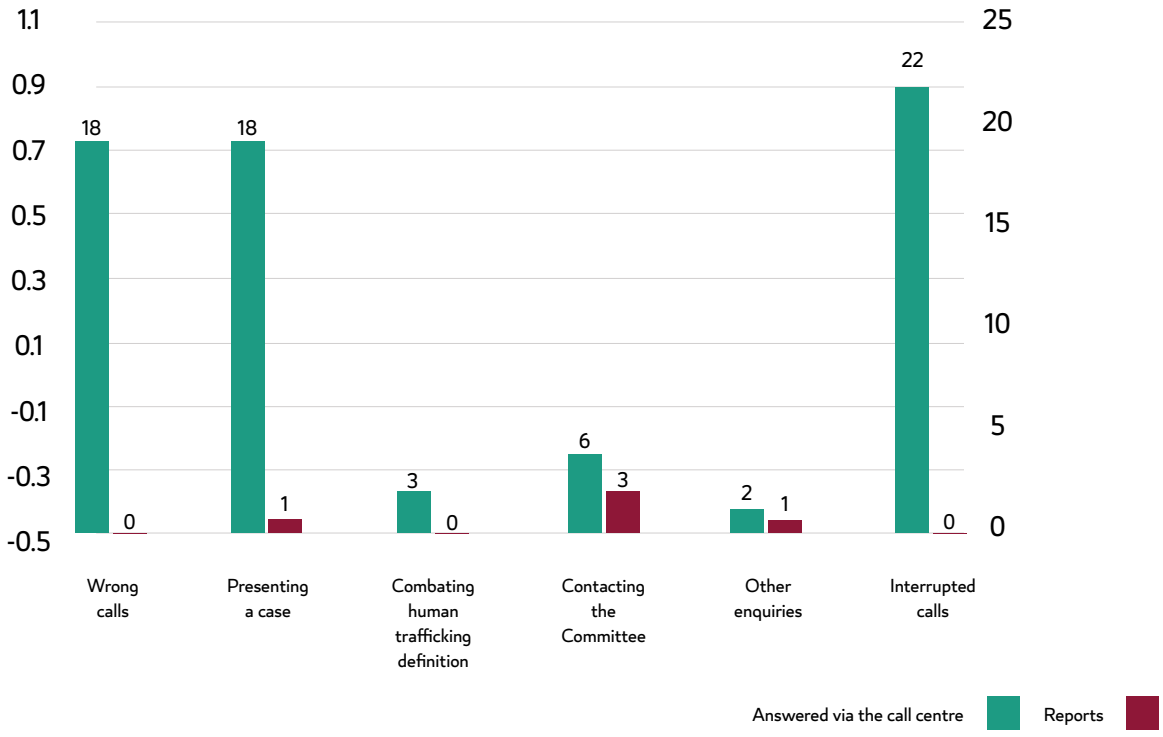
To ensure the effectiveness of the hotline, the Ministry has conducted specialized training workshops for supervisors and hotline operators. These workshops were designed to equip staff with the necessary skills and knowledge to enhance the efficiency of the hotline operations. Training covered essential aspects such as the recruitment process for 24/7 hotline staff, clarifying roles and responsibilities, and providing professional development for staff in critical areas such as hotline scheduling, equipment, system management, and contingency planning. Special emphasis was placed on response protocols and skills, ensuring that staff are well-prepared to handle calls appropriately and effectively, particularly in cases involving human trafficking.

The following tables provide a detailed breakdown of the number of calls handled throughout 2024.

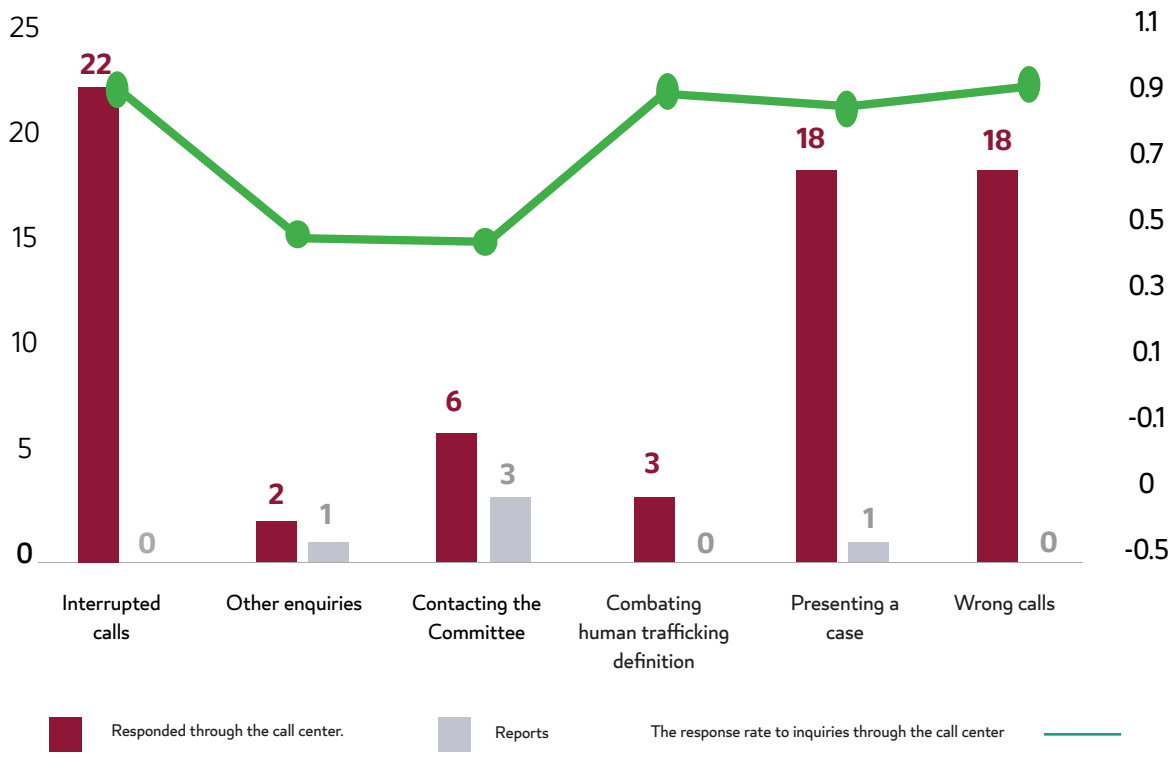
1. First Part: Calls Report

Call centre performance indicators	Throaughout the year
Incoming Calls	75
Answered Calls	75
Call Response Rate (%)	100%
Performance rate %	100%
Unanswered calls rate %	0%

Calls Report - 2024				
Entity	**Month**	**Received calls**	**Answered calls**	**Answered calls %**
National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking	January	6	6	100%
	February	4	4	100%
	March	3	3	100%
	April	4	4	100%
	May	6	6	100%
	June	5	5	100%
	July	5	5	100%
	August	15	15	100%
	September	14	14	100%
	October	5	5	100%
	November	4	4	100%
	December	4	4	100%



Types of Enquiries Report:			
Type	**Answered through call center**	**Reports**	**Response rate to enquiries via the call center**
Interrupted calls	22	0	100%
Other enquiries	2	1	50%
Contacting the Committee	6	3	50%
Combating human trafficking definition	3	0	100%
Presenting a case	18	1	94%
Wrong calls	18	0	100%


25
20
15
10
5
0
1.1
0.9
0.7
0.5
0.3
0.1
-0.1
0
-0.5
22
0
2
1
6
3
3
0
18
1
18
0
Interrupted calls
Other enquiries
Contacting the Committee
Combating human trafficking definition
Presenting a case
Wrong calls
Responded through the call center.
Reports
The response rate to inquiries through the call center

Section Three: Protection

Protection constitutes a fundamental pillar in efforts to combat human trafficking, aiming to provide a safe and supportive environment for victims, enabling them to reclaim their rights and dignity, and ensuring their access to justice and necessary assistance. In this context, the State of Qatar's 2024 National Report focuses on initiatives and mechanisms implemented to safeguard victims of human trafficking, including the provision of shelter, healthcare, psychological and social support, facilitation of access to justice, and enhancement of the legal and administrative framework to protect victims and prevent re-exploitation.

In 2024, Qatar continued to bolster its efforts in combating human trafficking and supporting its victims through several government-funded measures, including the establishment of care facilities such as the Humanitarian Care House and the Aman Care House, which are specifically designed to provide shelter and protection to victims of human trafficking.

The following outlines the key mechanisms and initiatives implemented to enhance protection for victims of human trafficking:

1. Humanitarian Care House:
   Managed by the Ministry of Labour, represented by the National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking, the Humanitarian Care House is dedicated to providing assistance and protection to victims of human trafficking, facilitating their rehabilitation, and supporting their reintegration into society. The facility comprises six villas and offers a range of services, including accommodation, meals, basic healthcare, legal support, internet access, repatriation assistance, and psychological services. The Care House exclusively caters to victims of human trafficking, providing essential social protection and care to those in need.

Additionally, the Aman Centre, a social protection and rehabilitation facility, delivers comprehensive social and healthcare services, specifically designed to protect and rehabilitate victims of human trafficking.

The Humanitarian Care House is recognised as one of Qatar's primary institutions dedicated to protecting and supporting victims of human trafficking. It is managed by the National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking in collaboration with both governmental and non-governmental entities to ensure that comprehensive services are provided to victims. All staff receive regular training to keep abreast of developments in human trafficking issues and to ensure that they are well-versed in the optimal support methods, including the relevant local and international laws and humanitarian procedures for assisting survivors. In 2024, more than three training programmes were organised for all staff at the Care House.

The following sections provide further details on the role and services offered by the Care House.

Main Role of the Care House:

- Provision of Secure Accommodation: Allocating safe living spaces for victims, ensuring protection from potential threats while maintaining their privacy and comfort.
- Legal Assistance: Offering legal support, including court representation when necessary, and facilitating the filing of criminal complaints against perpetrators in coordination with legal authorities.
- Psychological and Social Rehabilitation: Providing psychological support sessions and social programmes to aid victims in recovering from trauma and reintegrating into society.
- Healthcare Services: Delivering primary medical care, psychological therapy, and comprehensive health examinations to address health issues arising from trafficking.
- Skill Development and Employment Support: Offering training programmes to develop vocational skills and collaborating with relevant entities to facilitate employment opportunities post-rehabilitation.
- Legal Guidance: Educating victims about their rights and legal procedures, ensuring they are informed of their entitlements within the legal framework.
- Educational and Vocational Training: Providing language courses and vocational training to equip victims with necessary skills for independent living and societal reintegration.
- Multilingual Support: Offering translation services for non-Arabic or non-English speaking victims to facilitate effective communication.
- Non-Discrimination: Rendering services without bias regarding nationality, gender, or legal status, ensuring equitable support for all victims.
- Confidentiality and Security: Upholding rigorous confidentiality protocols to safeguard victims› personal information and ensure their safety throughout their stay.

Activities Conducted by the Care House during 2024:

1. Monitoring Residents› Conditions: Consistently observed the health, psychological well-being, and daily needs of its residents.
2. Psychological Support: Provided residents with psychological assistance through consultations with psychiatrists to aid in their rehabilitation process.
3. Resident Event (22 May 2024): The Ministry of Labour›s Awareness Department organised an event for the residents, fostering community and support.

4. Collaborative Activities: Hosted various activities in collaboration with the International Organization for Migration, aiming to provide comprehensive support and resources to the residents.

5. Student Visit (30 May 2024): Students from Newton British Academy, in partnership with Qatar Red Crescent, visited the Care House, engaging with residents and enriching their social experiences.

6. World Day Against Trafficking in Persons (30 July 2024): The National Committee to Combat Human Trafficking, along with members from the National Human Rights Committee, visited the Care House to commemorate this significant day, underscoring the nation›s commitment to combating human trafficking.

7. Provision of Resident Kits: Each resident received a personal kit containing essentials such as a towel, soap, toothpaste, toothbrush, shampoo, body lotion, bath loofah, and deodorant, ensuring their comfort and dignity.

8. Meal Provision: A total of 9,417 meals—comprising breakfast, lunch, and dinner—were served throughout the year, amounting to QAR 141,255. Continuous availability of sugar, tea, and milk was also ensured.

9. Psychological and Recreational Support: Maintained a conducive environment for residents› mental health by providing recreational facilities, including a television, PlayStation, Xbox, table tennis, and 24-hour internet access.

10. Provision of Clothing and Hygiene Items: Regularly supplied residents with new clothing and essential hygiene products, including shampoo, body lotion, soap, toothpaste, and laundry detergent, to maintain personal well-being.

11. Legal Assistance and Coordination: Maintained continuous communication with the Labour Complaints Department and the Labour Dispute Resolution Committee to monitor residents› legal statuses and ensure enforcement of their rights.

12. Resolution of Residents› Cases: Through diligent follow-up, successfully resolved the cases of 32 residents, securing owed rights either through the Labour Dispute Resolution Committee or directly via the Labour Complaints Department.

13. Facilitation of Residents› Transition: Assisted residents in transitioning from the Care House, either by securing new employment or facilitating their return to their home countries, supporting their reintegration into society.

14. Ongoing Legal Cases: For residents referred by the Criminal Investigation Department who had been at the Care House for over two months, coordination continued to expedite legal proceedings, with updates pending court decisions.

15. Long-Term Residents: Six residents from diverse nationalities, admitted in 2022, remained at the Care House for less than two months into 2023, with their cases under ongoing review.

Case Number	Nationality	Gender	Age Group	Deposited in Humanitarian Care House	Safe Return Secured to Home Country	Legal Status Adjusted
1/2024	Pakistan	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
2/2024	Uganda	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
3/2024	Uganda	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
4/2024	Uganda	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
5/2024	Uganda	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
6/2024	Uganda	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
7/2024	Uganda	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
8/2024	Uganda	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
9/2024	Uganda	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
10/2024	Uganda	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
11/2024	Uganda	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
12/2024	Uganda	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
13/2024	Uganda	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
14/2024	Uganda	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
15/2024	Uganda	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
16/2024	Uganda	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
17/2024	Uganda	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
18/2024	Uganda	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
19/2024	Uganda	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
20/2024	Uganda	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request

Case Number	Nationality	Gender	Age Group	Deposited in Humanitarian Care House	Safe Return Secured to Home Country	Legal Status Adjusted
21/2024	Uganda	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
22/2024	Philippines	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
23/2024	Thailand	Male	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
24/2024	Thailand	Male	Adult	Referred to Silayya Police	—	—
25/2024	Thailand	Male	Adult	Referred to Silayya Police	—	—
26/2024	Thailand	Male	Adult	Referred to Silayya Police	—	—
27/2024	Bangladesh	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
28/2024	India	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
29/2024	Bangladesh	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
30/2024	India	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
31/2024	Bangladesh	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
32/2024	India	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
33/2024	India	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
34/2024	Morocco	Male	Child	Deposited	Yes	Delivered under judicial mandate to Moroccan authorities
35/2024	Morocco	Male	Child	Deposited	Yes	Delivered under judicial mandate to Moroccan authorities
36/2024	Morocco	Male	Child	Deposited	Yes	Delivered under judicial mandate to Moroccan authorities
37/2024	Nigeria	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
38/2024	Nigeria	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
39/2024	Nigeria	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request

Case Number	Nationality	Gender	Age Group	Deposited in Humanitarian Care House	Safe Return Secured to Home Country	Legal Status Adjusted
40/2024	Nigeria	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
41/2024	Nigeria	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
42/2024	Nigeria	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
43/2024	Nigeria	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
44/2024	Nigeria	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
45/2024	Nigeria	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
46/2024	Nigeria	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
47/2024	Nigeria	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
48/2024	Nigeria	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
49/2024	Nigeria	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
50/2024	Kenya	Female	Adult	Deposited	Yes	Left upon their own request
51/2024	Morocco	Male	Adult	—	Yes	Left upon their own request
52/2024	Morocco	Male	Adult	—	Yes	Left upon their own request
53/2024	Morocco	Male	Adult	—	Yes	Left upon their own request

Victims transferred to other departments	Victims whose status has been adjusted in the country	Victims whose repatriation has been secured	Currently filed victims	Total number of victims
81	16	56	10	7

Last update: 09/04/2025

Development of Human Trafficking Indicators in the State of Qatar

Human trafficking is considered one of the most egregious violations of human rights, as it deprives individuals of their freedom and dignity. Despite global efforts to combat this crime, effective action requires heightened international awareness, cooperation, and continuous coordination.

The State of Qatar is committed to combating human trafficking, guided by Islamic Sharia principles, its Constitution, and laws that prohibit all forms of human exploitation, with an emphasis on respect for human dignity and the protection of rights. Beyond enacting relevant legislation, Qatar has focussed on implementing and enforcing these laws through effective mechanisms.

Recognising the importance of identifying trafficking victims, Qatar has developed key indicators to assist professionals in various sectors—such as security, justice, healthcare, and social services—in accurately identifying and distinguishing victims. This approach facilitates their rescue and ensures access to the necessary assistance and protection. In response to rapid technological advancements that criminals may exploit in trafficking, Qatar has duly updated these indicators.

A. General Indicators of Human Trafficking:

First responders are advised to consider the following general indicators, as outlined by Qatar's National Committee to Combat Human Trafficking, to identify and assist victims: Initial Contact with the Victim: Presence of signs of violence, physical disabilities, poor hygiene, or malnutrition.

1. **Victim's Behaviour:**
   Reluctance to communicate freely; signs of control or surveillance by exploiters; limited social interaction; fear of legal repercussions; or restricted freedom of movement.

2. **Psychological State:**
   Manifestations of fear, anxiety, limited social interaction, or psychological distress resulting from exploitation, including fear of legal consequences and threats from family members.

3. **Travel Documents:**
   Possession of fraudulent identity documents or cases where documents are withheld by employers.

Individuals subjected to trafficking may also exhibit additional signs, including:

- Controlled movements or constant surveillance.
- Restricted freedom of movement within certain areas.
- A belief that they must work against their will.
- A perception of being encumbered by debts.
- Visible signs of fear or anxiety.
- Physical injuries indicative of abuse.
- Threats of harm to themselves or their families.

- Occupational injuries consistent with certain types of work.

- Fear of law enforcement or deportation.
- Lack of personal identification documents.
- Limited proficiency in the local language.
- Uncertainty regarding their residential or work address.
- Reluctance to speak without others present.
- Behaviour suggesting instructions from another party.
- An inability to negotiate work conditions.
- Receiving minimal or no payment.
- Exposure to physical or verbal abuse.
- Being forced to work under exploitative conditions.
- Inability to access their earned wages.
- No provision of rest days.
- Excessively long working hours.
- Limited or no contact with family or outsiders.
- Restrictions on free communication.
- Living in substandard or inadequate housing.
- Denial of medical care.
- Recruitment based on false pretences.
- Originating from regions known for human trafficking.
- Association with locations commonly linked to exploitation.
- Payment of fees for transportation with an expectation to work in order to repay these amounts upon arrival.

• B. Indicators Developed to Assist First Responders in Identifying Human Trafficking Cases:

Num	Indicators of forced or compulsory labour in domestic work
1.	The victims cannot leave their workplace.
2.	There is signs that someone is controlling their movements and that their will is being stolen.
3.	They look scared or anxious.
4.	Reported missing by their employer even though they are still at home.
5.	They are subjected to violence or threats of violence against them or their family members.
6.	They have injuries that appear to be the result of an assault.
7.	They are threatened with being handed over to the authorities.
8.	They do not trust the authorities.
9.	They do not have travel documents or any personal identification.
10.	They allow other people to speak on their behalf when directly addressed.
11.	They receive little or no pay.
12.	They work long hours.
13.	They have no days off.
14.	They live in poor or low-quality housing conditions.
15.	They do not have access to medical care.
16.	Intermediaries have paid money on their behalf to reach the destination country, and they are forced to work or provide services in the destination country to repay the intermediaries.
17.	They have no private space to stay and sleep.

Num	Indicators of victims of labour exploitation.
1.	Victims live in groups and in the same workplace and rarely or never leave.
2.	They live in places that are not suitable for housing, such as agricultural or industrial buildings.
3.	They are not dressed appropriately for the work they do, i.e. they may lack protective equipment or warm clothing.
4.	They do not have a labour contract.
5.	Their working hours are long.
6.	They have injuries that appear to be the result of an assault.
7.	They are threatened with being handed over to the authorities.
8.	They do not trust the authorities.
9.	They do not have travel documents or any personal identification.
10.	They allow other people to speak on their behalf when directly addressed.
11.	They receive little or no pay.
12.	They have no days off.
13.	They do not have access to medical care.
14.	Intermediaries have paid money on their behalf to reach the destination country, and they are forced to work or provide services in the destination country to repay the intermediaries.
15.	They are penalised with fines.
16.	They lack basic training and professional licences.

Num	Indicators of Child Victims
1.	They are unable to contact their parents, guardians or relatives.
2.	They appear fearful and behave in a way that is inconsistent with typical behaviour of children their age.
3.	They have no friends their age outside of work.
4.	They don't have access to education.
5.	They don't have time to play.
6.	They live away from other children and in low-quality accommodation.
7.	They are engaged in work that is not suitable for children.
8.	They don't have travel documents or any personal identification.
9.	They allow other people to speak on their behalf when they are directly addressed.
10.	They have child-sized clothes that are the same size as those worn by manual labourers or sex workers.
11.	Children's toys, beds and clothes are found in inappropriate places such as brothels and factories.
12.	They are living in poor or substandard housing conditions.
13.	They do not have access to medical care.

Num	Indicators of Child Victims
1.	Sextortion: Requests to send sexual images or videos under the threat of posting embarrassing photos or personal information.
2.	Forced online labour: The exploitation of people to work for long periods of time under threat or in exchange for false promises, such as promises of work or immigration.
3.	Child Grooming: Repeated contact with minors and attempts to build a close relationship for the purpose of sexual exploitation.
4.	Phishing: Luring victims to obtain personal or financial information that is later exploited for commercial or criminal purposes.
5.	Forced transfer of funds: Asking the victim to transfer money to an unknown person or buy gift cards and transfer them abroad.
6.	Catfishing: Using fake online identities to create exploitative relationships or ask for money.
7.	Pressure to send sensitive data: Attempting to obtain information such as bank account numbers or identity documents to steal or exploit.
8.	False enticing offers: Offering fake job offers or grants online as a way to lure victims into illegal activities.
9.	Online recruitment: Recruiting individuals, especially minors, to engage in criminal or exploitative activities such as online prostitution.
10.	Emotional manipulation: Exploiting emotions and trust to coerce victims to perform certain actions such as sending money or engaging in illegal activities.

Num	Indicators of victims of organised begging
1.	They are likely to be children, the elderly, women or people with special needs, often begging in public places, roads, traffic lights, gathering places and events.
2.	Improper appearance or obvious negligence: Clothing is dirty or unsuitable for the weather, and there may be signs of malnutrition or lack of health care.
3.	Mass transportation: Victims are transported en masse in specific vehicles, often with the same people returning to the same locations daily. They belong to gangs made up of members of the same nationality.
4.	Forcing children to beg: Young children are found on the streets repeatedly asking for money, they may have physical disabilities or fake injuries.
5.	Someone is watching the victim: There is often an adult or group watching the victim up close or from afar, telling them what to do or how to behave. Threatened with being handed over to the authorities.
6.	They do not have travel documents or any personal identification.
7.	Fear or reluctance to speak: The victim shows signs of fear or nervousness when talking to strangers, especially if they are asked why they are on the street.
8.	They are not going to school or work: Children or teenagers who are constantly on the street instead of going to school.
9.	They pass long hours in the sun and in unfavourable weather conditions.
10.	They are subjected to humiliation, abuse, threats, or violence. They receive little or no pay.
11.	They live in poor or substandard housing conditions.
12.	Have untreated chronic health conditions: The victim may have obvious health issues or injuries without any signs of proper treatment.
13.	False or exaggerated physical conditions: The victim may present fake or exaggerated injuries or disabilities to attract sympathy and maximise their chances of getting paid.

Num	Signs of Victims of Sexual Exploitation
1.	The victim cannot leave their workplace.
2.	Their movements are controlled, and their will is stolen.
3.	They appear fearful or anxious.
4.	They have been subjected to violence or threats of violence against them and their family members.
5.	They have injuries that appear to be the result of an assault.
6.	They are threatened with being handed over to the authorities.
7.	They do not trust the authorities.
8.	They do not have travel documents or any personal identification.
9.	They allow others to speak on their behalf when directly addressed.
10.	They receive little or no pay.
11.	They work very long hours over long periods of time.
12.	They have no holidays.
13.	They live in poor or substandard housing conditions.
14.	They do not have access to medical care.
15.	Intermediaries have paid money on their behalf to reach the destination country, and they have to work or provide services in the destination country to repay the intermediaries.
16.	They have a perception that they are in debt.
17.	They only know the local language or the language of the clients with whom they are doing business, and only know words related to sex.
18.	Most of their clothes are of the type normally worn for sex work.
19.	They have tattoos or other markings on their bodies that indicate 'ownership' by their exploiters.
20.	There is evidence of potential victims being able to refuse unprotected and/or violent sex.
21.	They could be of any age group, although this age group varies by location and market.
22.	Evidence of online sexual exploitation.

3. Alignment of National Legislation with International Conventions on Combating Human Trafficking

Firstly, it is noteworthy that the State of Qatar, owing to its modest geographical size and limited population, does not exhibit the prevalence of organised criminal groups as outlined in certain international conventions. Nonetheless, Qatar has proactively enacted national legislation imposing stringent penalties for such offences. This includes the Penal Code No. (11) of 2004 and its amendments, as well as Law No. (15) of 2011 on Combating Human Trafficking and its subsequent amendments. Qatar has consistently introduced numerous legislative measures that align with the objectives of international conventions and their supplementary protocols. These measures encompass:

1. **Amendments to the Qatari Labour Law No. (14) of 2004, which include:**

- The issuance of Ministerial Decision No. (4) of 2015, establishing regulations for the Wage Protection System, mandating employers to transfer workers› wages to financial institutions within seven days of their due dates, and empowering the Ministry of Labour's Inspection Department to enforce compliance.

- The establishment of Labour Dispute Settlement Committees under Council of Ministers Decision No. (6) of 2018, as amended by Decision No. (17) of 2022, aimed at enhancing access to justice.

- The creation of the Workers' Support and Insurance Fund through Law No. (17) of 2018, designed to protect workers' financial entitlements in cases of employer insolvency or closure, thereby ensuring their rights and access to a safe working environment.

- The issuance of Ministerial Decision No. (21) of 2019, which regulates the election of worker representatives in joint committees within establishments employing 30 or more individuals, thereby facilitating the discussion of work-related issues.

- The implementation of Ministerial Decision No. (25) of 2020, which establishes minimum wage standards for domestic workers.

- The enactment of Decree-Law No. (18) of 2020, amending certain provisions of the Labour Law to permit either party to terminate employment contracts post-probationary period with prior notice, with notice periods specified according to tenure.

- The issuance of Ministerial Decision No. (17) of 2021, which outlines the necessary precautions to protect workers from heat stress in outdoor workplaces during summer months.

- The complete abolition of the Kafala sponsorship system and the transition to a contract-based employment framework, thereby granting workers the freedom to change employers without needing prior consent from current sponsors.

- The establishment of 14 Qatar Visa Centres across six countries (the Philippines, India, Sri Lanka, Nepal, Bangladesh, and Pakistan) to streamline the recruitment process and safeguard workers› rights by eliminating exploitative practices in their home countries.

2. The enactment of Law No. (22) of 2005, which prohibits the recruitment, employment, training, or involvement of children in camel racing.

3. The establishment of the Social Protection and Rehabilitation Centre under Law No. (21) of 2006 concerning private institutions of public benefit. This centre, operating under the Qatar Social Work Foundation, aims to rehabilitate and reintegrate victims of human trafficking by providing shelter, legal assistance, and coordination with international bodies for victim support.

4. The enactment of Law No. (15) of 2011 on Combating Human Trafficking, as amended by Law No. (5) of 2020 and Law No. (21) of 2024. This law criminalises all forms of human trafficking and prescribes penalties—including imprisonment and fines—with enhanced sanctions for offences involving vulnerable victims or aggravating circumstances.

5. The introduction of Law No. (14) of 2014 concerning the combating of electronic crimes, which criminalises the exploitation of children in the production, distribution, or possession of pornographic materials via information technology, with penalties including imprisonment and fines.

6. The enactment of Law No. (21) of 2015 regulating the entry, exit, and residency of expatriates, as amended by Decree-Law No. (19) of 2020, which abolished exit permits, thereby allowing expatriate workers to leave Qatar without prior employer consent, and prohibited employers from confiscating workers' passports.

7. The passage of Law No. (15) of 2015 concerning the regulation of human organ transplantation, which aims to prevent organ trafficking by establishing a legal framework for organ donation and transplantation, accompanied by stringent penalties for violations.

8. The enactment of Law No. (15) of 2017 regarding domestic workers, which sets out their rights and protections, including provisions

on working hours, rest periods, and conditions for termination of employment.

9. The establishment of a dedicated Combating Human Trafficking Unit within the Ministry of Interior›s Criminal Investigation Department, specialising in human trafficking and migrant smuggling offences, and providing a hotline for reporting related complaints.

10. Establishment of a dedicated Public Prosecution unit within the Residency Affairs Prosecution to investigate human trafficking cases. This specialised unit focuses on crimes related to human trafficking and migrant smuggling. Correspondingly, the Court of Appeal has established a dedicated chamber to adjudicate such cases.

11. Enactment of Law No. (20) of 2019 on Combating Money Laundering and Terrorism Financing: This law represents a significant step in the fight against human trafficking, as it criminalises money laundering and terrorism financing arising from all crimes. Article 2 of the law stipulates that any person who intentionally engages in any of the following actions is considered to have committed the crime of money laundering:

    – Transferring or moving money, knowing that it is the proceeds of a crime or involved in the commission of such a crime, with the intent to conceal or disguise the unlawful source of the funds, or assisting any person who has committed the crime in evading the legal consequences of their actions.

    – Concealing or disguising the true nature, source, location, manner of disposal, movement, ownership, or rights related to the funds, knowing that they are the proceeds of a crime.

    – Acquiring, possessing, or using money, knowing at the time of receipt that it is the proceeds of a crime.

    – Participating, associating, conspiring, assisting, inciting, facilitating, providing advice, cooperating, contributing, or conspiring in the commission of, or attempting to commit, any of the acts specified in this article.

Money laundering is considered a distinct crime, separate from the underlying crime. When it is proven that the funds are the proceeds of a crime, it is not necessary to convict the individual of committing the underlying crime. The punishment for the original crime does not preclude punishment for the crime of money laundering. In accordance with this law, a Seizure and Confiscation Office was established within the Public Prosecution, as provided by Article 91.

12. Creation of a specialised chamber within the Court of Appeal to hear human trafficking cases, ensuring focused judicial attention on these matters.

13. Issuance of Law No. (2) of 2020 amending certain provisions of the Penal Code No. (11) of 2004: This amendment aims to address specific aspects of human trafficking. Article 3, concerning «Crimes Related to Organised Criminal Groups,» stipulates that anyone who forms, participates in, or joins an organised criminal group of three or more persons – with the intent to commit crimes to obtain, directly or indirectly, a financial or material benefit – is liable to imprisonment for a term of not less than three years and not exceeding five years, and a fine not exceeding QAR 100,000. The same penalties apply to any person who assists, incites, facilitates, counsels, cooperates, contributes, or conspires in the commission of such acts, with enhanced penalties prescribed for those who lead or organise the group.

14. Issuance of Decision No. (37) of 2022 by the Chief Justice: This decision reallocates judicial competencies to establish a criminal division specifically for hearing human trafficking cases.

15. Enactment of Law No. (5) of 2022 concerning the protection of victims and witnesses: This legislation extends protection to victims of human trafficking by providing safeguards against retaliation and ensuring support for their participation in legal proceedings.

4. Enhancement of Law Enforcement Officials' Capacities:

In its commitment to strengthening the capabilities of officials responsible for enforcing human trafficking laws, the State of Qatar has initiated a comprehensive array of programmes aimed at elevating proficiency and fostering collaboration among pertinent entities. The national anti-trafficking community comprises key stakeholders, including members and secretariat staff of the National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking (NCCHT) at the Ministry of Labour, officers from the Ministry of Interior›s Human Rights Department, prosecutors from the Human Trafficking Prosecution Unit, and judges from the specialised criminal court handling human trafficking cases.

A pivotal initiative in this endeavour is the establishment of a national anti-trafficking community that benefits from targeted training and advisory services. This initiative has facilitated the organisation of numerous training sessions and workshops, both domestically and internationally. For instance, in November 2024, concerned officials participated in a training course entitled «Capacity Building in Combating Human Trafficking,»

organised by the Criminal Studies Institute in collaboration with the Supreme Judicial Council and the U.S. Embassy. The programme also included field visits to Washington, D.C. and Boston to observe the approaches of U.S. agencies in handling human trafficking cases.

Qatar actively collaborates with various international and local institutions in capacity-building programmes, such as:

- The U.S. Department of State's Bureau of Democracy, Human Rights, and Labor;
- The Syracuse University Institute for International Commercial Law, Italy;
- The Hague Institute for Global Justice;
- The United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime – Global Forum on Human Trafficking;
- The Vienna Forum to Fight Human Trafficking, Austria;
- The United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime – Kenya; and
- The Criminal Studies Institute – Public Prosecution of Qatar. Furthermore, the Supreme Judicial Council places significant emphasis on enhancing judges' competencies in handling human trafficking cases by providing specialised legal training. This specialisation is incorporated into capacity-building plans for the years 2020–2024, with notable initiatives including:

1. Permanent membership in the National Task Force to Enhance Combating Human Trafficking Efforts.
2. The establishment of a judicial circuit dedicated to human trafficking cases.
3. Participation of judges in national and international seminars in collaboration with global entities.
4. The inclusion of combating human trafficking measures in international judicial cooperation plans with countries such as the United Kingdom, China, and Italy. The Council further commits to training judges on the judicial code of conduct, aligning with international standards to uphold judicial integrity and independence, thereby reinforcing the rule of law and combating human trafficking. In 2024, the budget allocated for capacity-building and training programmes for officials enforcing human trafficking laws amounted to approximately QAR 4 million (equivalent to USD 1,100,000). This investment underscores the Qatari government's dedication to supporting anti-trafficking initiatives by enhancing the capabilities of relevant authorities and providing specialised training for their personnel. The budget distribution across various government entities involved in funding and implementing these programmes is as follows:

- Supreme Judicial Council: Allocated approximately QAR 1,500,000 (USD 410,000) to support training programmes aimed at enhancing judges' proficiency in handling human trafficking cases.
- Public Prosecution: Dedicated around QAR 920,000 (USD 252,000) to finance workshops and training courses organised by the Criminal Studies Institute, targeting public prosecutors and other relevant officials.
- Ministry of Interior: Assigned approximately QAR 1,300,000 (USD 356,000) to bolster training for law enforcement officers in the field of combating human trafficking.
- National Committee for Combating Human Trafficking: Allocated about QAR 300,000 (USD 82,000) for training programmes aimed at enhancing the roles of employees in the Labour Disputes Department, Labour Inspection Department, and shelter services for victims.

These strategic investments reflect Qatar›s unwavering commitment to combating human trafficking through the continuous development of its legal and enforcement frameworks.

5. Statistics and Classifications of Human Trafficking Reports

Cases referred by the Combating Human Trafficking Section to the Public Prosecution and the type of disposition for 2024

	Case number	Type of exploitation	Number of accused	Gender of accused	Nationality of accused	Nationality of victims	Number of victims	Gender of victims	Care House	Complaints and related issues	International cooperation	Final disposition
1.	2024/1	Sexual exploitation	(8) natural persons. (3) legal persons (companies)	8 males and 3 companies	Pakistan / Bangladesh / Qatar	Pakistan	Four (4) victims were placed in the Care House and their return to their country was secured according to their wishes	Female	Yes		Absent	Imprisonment of the first and second defendants for ten years, the third defendant for five years, and the fourth to eighth defendants for six months, with the deportation of all defendants + a fine of QR 50,000 for the accused and QR 50,000 for the companies accused in the complaint.

	Case number	Type of exploitation	Number of accused	Gender of accused	Nationality of accused	Nationality of victims	Number of victims	Gender of victims	Care House	Complaints and related issues	International cooperation	Final disposition
2.	2024/2	Suspicion of forced labour	One (1) natural person and one (1) legal person (company)	Company	Qatar	Uganda	18 victims were placed in the Care House and later handed over to their recruiters	Female	Yes	Ministry of Labour Department of Labour Complaints	Absent	Exclusion of suspicion, referral of failure to provide housing, and a fine of ten thousand riyals
3.	2024/3	Suspicion of sexual exploitation	Six (6) natural persons and one (1) legal person (company	males6 and one (1) legal person	Bangladesh	Thailand	The victim (1) was sheltered and later repatriated to his home country upon his own request	Male	Yes		Absent	Save - No Case Order and copy the report file to Al Rayyan Police
4.	2024/4	Suspicion of forced labour	Two (2) natural persons and one (1) legal person (company)	Females and a company	India / Qatar	Bangladesh / India	The victims (7) were sheltered and later repatriated to their home country upon their own request	Female	Yes		Absent	Exclusion of suspicion and referral of failure to provide housing and acquittal.
5.	2024/6	Migrants smuggling and exploitation of a child	One (1) natural person	Male	Morocco	Morocco	Four (4) victims were sheltered and later handed over to the authorities in their country	Males	Yes		Yes - Authorities in Morocco, Spain and Malaysia have jurisdiction	Five years' imprisonment + a fine of 200,000 riyals and deportation.

	Case number	Type of exploitation	Number of accused	Gender of accused	Nationality of accused	Nationality of victims	Number of victims	Gender of victims	Care House	Complaints and related issues	International cooperation	Final disposition
6..	2024/7	Sexual exploitation	Two (2) natural persons	Females	Nigeria	Nigeria	The victims (13) were sheltered and later repatriated to their home country upon their own request	Female	Yes	Capital Security Department - Capital Police (8827/2024)	Absent	The first defendant was imprisoned for 15 years, the second defendant was acquitted, and the defendant was fined 100,000 riyals with deportation and closure of the place. The judgement was appealed by the prosecution.
7.	2024/8	Sexual exploitation	Three (3) natural persons and one (1) legal person (company)	3 males and one (1) legal person	Morocco / Qatar	Morocco	The victims (6) were sheltered and later repatriated to their home country upon their own request	Male	No	Research and Follow-up (2024/1999)	Absent	The court sentenced the defendants to 7 years in prison, fined them 100,000 QAR each, closed the company and fined the company 200,000 QAR with closure
8.	2024/9	Sexual exploitation	Two (2) normal persons	Males	Bangladesh	Bangladesh	Two (2) victims have been housed in the Care House to date	Females	Yes		Absent	Deliberated in court and for the submission of closing briefs 808/01/2025

	Case number	Type of exploitation	Number of accused	Gender of accused	Nationality of accused	Nationality of victims	Number of victims	Gender of victims	Care House	Complaints and related issues	International cooperation	Final disposition
9.	2024/10	Migrants smuggling and exploitation of a child	Two (2) normal persons	Males	Egypt	Egypt	Four (4) victims were sheltered and later handed over to the authorities in their country	Male	Yes		Yes - there is a judicial delegation of authority in Egypt	The victims and the file of the proceedings were handed over to the Egyptian authorities
10.	2024/11	Suspicion of sexual exploitation	Four (4) normal persons	Males	Pakistan / Nepal	Pakistan	The victim (1) was sheltered and the report was later referred to the competent prosecution for lack of jurisdiction	Female	No		Absent	Save and transfer its copies to the Capital Prosecution
11.	2024/12	Sexual exploitation	Four (4) natural persons and one (1) legal person (company)	Males / Females	Bangladesh	Bangladesh	One (1) victim has been housed in the Care House to date	Females	Yes		Absent	Ten years for the first defendant, five years for the second defendant and a fine of 50,000 riyals, and six months for the third defendant.
12.	2024/13	Migrants smuggling and exploitation of a child	One (1) normal person	Female	Malaysia	Sri Lanka	One (1) victim has been housed in the Care House to date	Female	Yes		Yes - there are jurisdictions in Malaysia, Sri Lanka and Thailand	Sentenced to five years and a fine of 50,000 QAR and deported from the country upon execution of the sentence

	Case number	Type of exploitation	Number of accused	Gender of accused	Nationality of accused	Nationality of victims	Number of victims	Gender of victims	Care House	Complaints and related issues	International cooperation	Final disposition
13.	2024/14	Suspicion of sexual exploitation	Two (2) normal persons	Males	Bangladesh	Bangladesh	The victim (1) was sheltered and the report was later referred to the competent prosecution for lack of jurisdiction	Female	Yes	Capital Security Department / Capital Police (15533/2024	Absent	Save and transfer its copies to the Capital Prosecution
14.	2024/15	Sexual exploitation	Two (2) normal persons	Males / Females	Uganda / Kenya	Kenya	One (1) victim has been housed in the Care House to date	Female	Yes	Musaimir Police Department (17625/2024)	Absent	In the court
15.	2024/16	Sexual exploitation	Two (2) normal persons	Males / Females	Pakistan / Bangladesh	Pakistan	One (1) victim has been housed in the Care House to date	Females	Yes	Capital Security Department (17657/2024)	Absent	In the court
12.	2024/13	Forced labour	One (1) natural person and one (1) legal person (company)	Male	Egypt	Kenya	Ten (10) victims have been housed in the Care House	Female	Yes	Research and Follow-up Department (9) reports (26632/2024 26636/2024 ___ 26630/2024 - 26630/2024 - 26638/2024___ 26639/2024 - 26636/2024 ___ 26635/2024 ___ ___ 26645/2024 26643/2024___)	Absent	In the court
Total		Number of cases: - (7) Sexual exploitation (1) Forced labour (3) Human trafficking and migrant smuggling - child exploitation (3) Suspected sexual exploitation (2) Suspected forced labour Total: 16 cases	Number of defendants: - (43) natural persons (7) legal persons				Number of victims: 75					

- **Suspicion exclusion:** Suspicion exclusion means that the Public Prosecution has conducted a judicial investigation into the case and changed the description of the offence to exclude the crime of human trafficking.

- **Save the case and copy:** It means that the Public Prosecution investigated the case file, saved the case and ordered a copy of the case for referral to the competent prosecution or the competent authority.

- **Complaints and related cases:** The term complaints and linked cases means that the prosecution received the case as a case that is not a human trafficking case, but after the public prosecution›s investigations, the prosecution categorised it as a human trafficking case.

- Last updated: 09/04/2025

Recommendations:

1. Continue to raise awareness of the crime of human trafficking and its various forms among all segments of society by incorporating it into the educational curriculum in a logical sequence.

2. `Expand training programmes on the enforcement of anti-trafficking laws for judicial authorities, ensuring that courts uphold trafficking charges against defendants when appropriate.

3. Increase the number of investigations into trafficking offences, particularly by examining cases involving passport confiscation, withhold wages, labour violations, and abuse complaints as potential indicators of trafficking.

4. Broaden training for law enforcement agencies to better identify potential trafficking crimes, especially for officers in specialised trafficking units within the Ministry of Interior.

5. Promote the establishment and strengthening of national funds dedicated to supporting trafficking victims, sourcing contributions from the State, civil society organisations, and the private sector.

6. Enhance internet surveillance to detect and apprehend traffickers and networks involved in human trafficking and collaborate with service providers to block websites implicated in such activities.

7. Continue to review and align current legislation with international standards, ensuring compatibility with technological advancements.

8. Expand awareness campaigns on human trafficking concepts through international cooperation, capacity-building, training, and the exchange of experiences, while leveraging successful models and coordinating closely with Gulf Cooperation Council countries on anti-trafficking efforts.

9. Consolidate international and national efforts to effectively combat the global issue of human trafficking and eradicate it at its roots.



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